



LEARNING

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

- ▶ Define learning
- ▶ Recognize and define three basic forms of learning—
classical conditioning, operant conditioning, and
observational learning

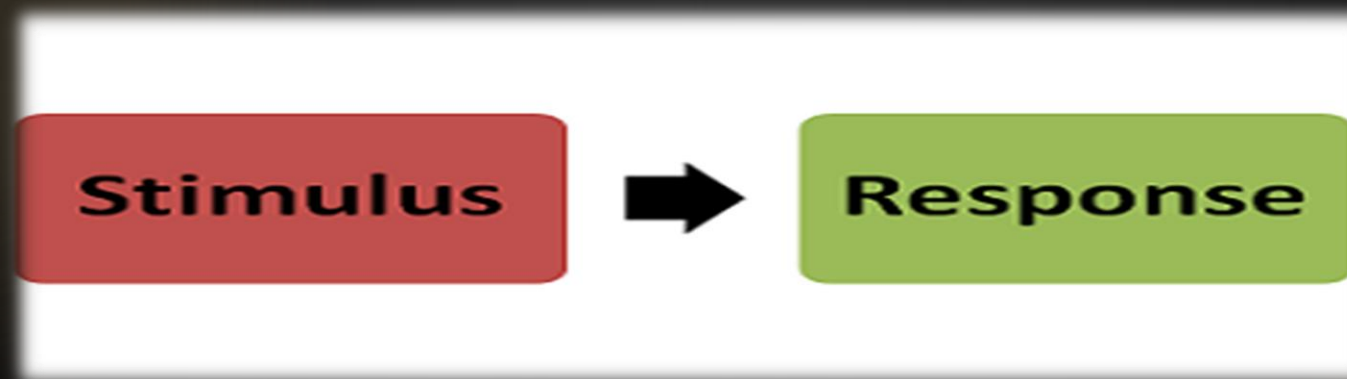
Learning

- ▶ Learning is the act of acquiring new or modifying existing knowledge, behaviors, skills, values, or preferences and may involve synthesizing different types of information.
- ▶ It is a relative permanent change in behavior or mental state based on experience.
- ▶ Learning may occur consciously or unconsciously.





- ▶ **STIMULUS** – it is an external and internal change which generates the response of the body.
- ▶ Any event, any object that triggers a **sensory or behavioral** response in an organism
- ▶ **RESPONSE** – reaction or response shown by the organism.



LEARNING

- ▶ **Associative leaning**

Classical conditioning

Operant conditioning

- ▶ **Observational Learning**

11. Associative Learning

- ▶ Associative learning: is the process by which an association between two stimuli is involved.
- ▶ It involves the presence of paired stimuli in order for change to occur.
- ▶ Learning about the relationship between two separate stimuli.

(Classical Learning, Operant Learning)

Important terminology

- ▶ **CONDITIONED** – learned
- ▶ **UNCONDITIONED** -unlearned

Classical Conditioning



Classical Conditioning – Pavlovian” or “Respondent Conditioning”.

- ❑ First described by Ivan Pavlov, a Russian physiologist.
- ❑ **"Focuses on involuntary, automatic behaviors/responses"**.
- ❑ Two stimuli are linked together to produce a new learned response in a person or animal.
- ❑ This learning process creates a **conditioned response** through associations between an Unconditioned stimulus (US) and a Neutral stimulus (NS).

Pavlov's Dog Experiment:



► Phase 1: Before Conditioning

The first part of the classical conditioning process requires a naturally occurring stimulus that will automatically elicit a response.

Presenting food (the UCS) naturally and automatically triggers a salivation response (the UCR).

UCS-----UCR

During Conditioning



Unconditioned response

► Phase 2: During Conditioning

During the second phase of the classical conditioning process, the previously neutral stimulus is repeatedly paired with the unconditioned stimulus. As a result of this pairing, an association between the previously neutral stimulus (bell ring) and the UCS (food) is formed.

Eventually, the neutral stimulus becomes the conditioned stimulus. (bell ring)

UCS+NS-----UCR

After Conditioning



► Phase 3: After Conditioning

Once the association has been made between the UCS and the CS, presenting the conditioned stimulus alone will come to evoke a response. i.e.: CR (SALIVATION).

In the **after-conditioning** phase, the conditioned stimulus alone triggers the conditioned response.

CS-----CR

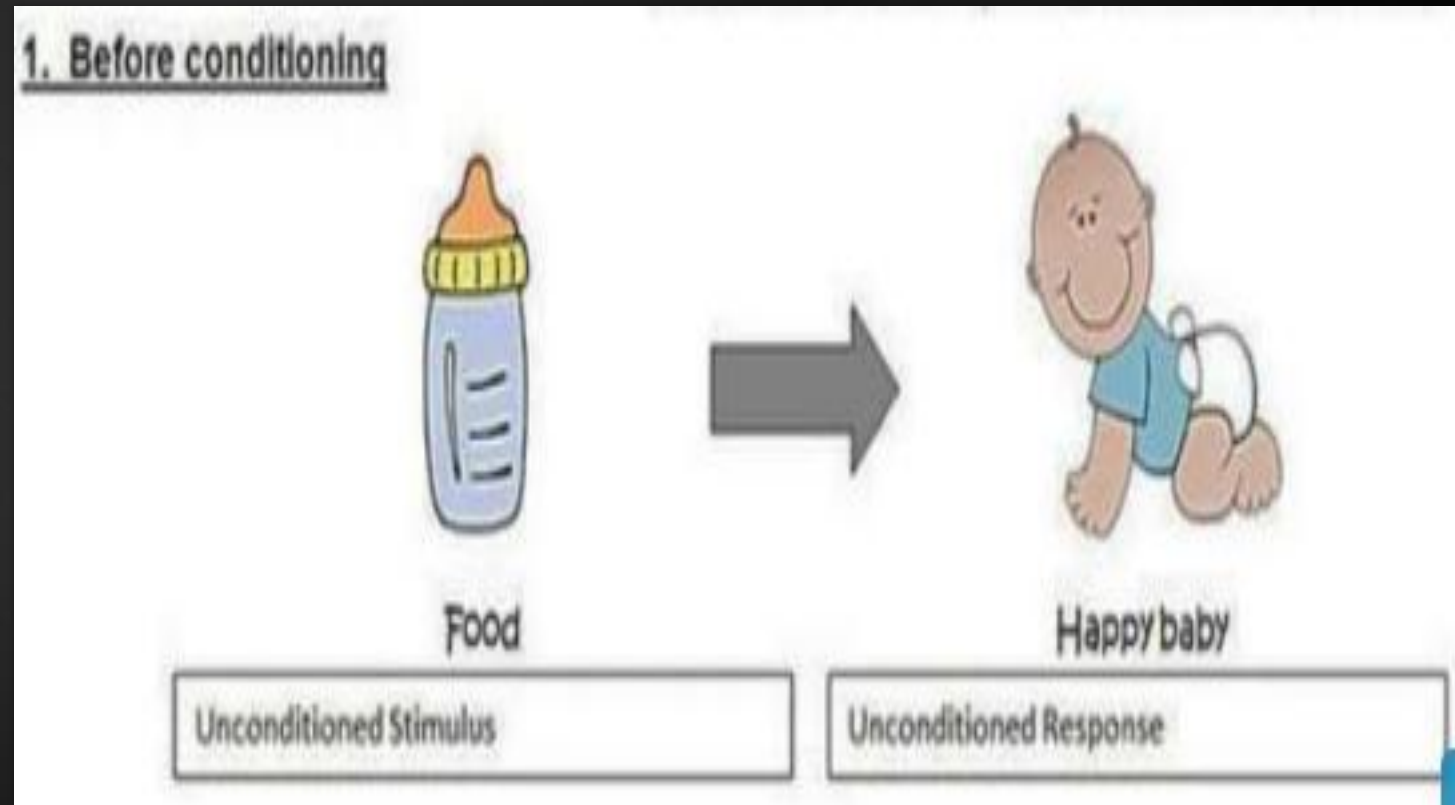
Stage 1: Before Conditioning

► The Unconditioned Stimulus (UCS):

The unconditioned stimulus is one that unconditionally, naturally, and automatically triggers a response.

► The Unconditioned Response (UCR):

The unconditioned response is the unlearned response that occurs naturally in response to the unconditioned stimulus.



Stage 2 During Conditioning

► The Neutral Stimulus

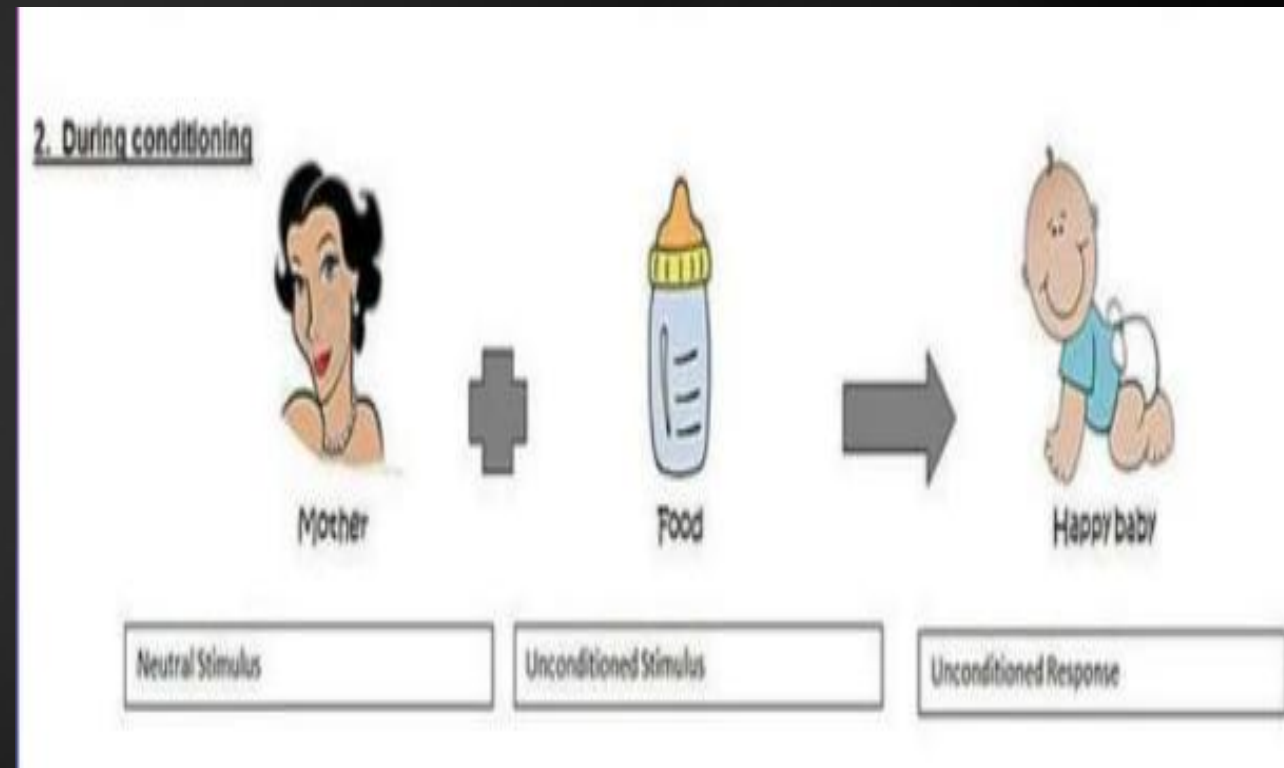
Another stimulus which has no affect on a person.

It could be a person, object, place etc.

The NS in classical conditioning does not produce a response until it is paired with the unconditioned stimulus.

► The Conditioned Stimulus

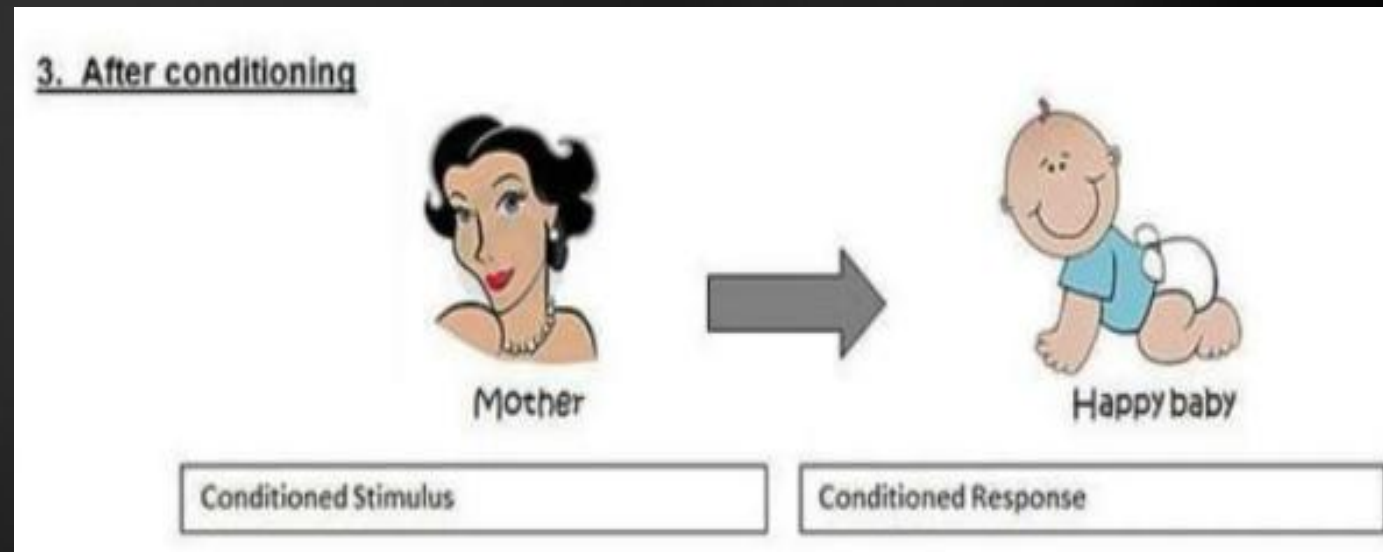
The conditioned stimulus is previously neutral stimulus that, after becoming associated with the unconditioned stimulus, eventually comes to trigger a conditioned response.



Stage 3 : After Conditioning

► The Conditioned Response

The conditioned response is the learned response to the previously neutral stimulus.

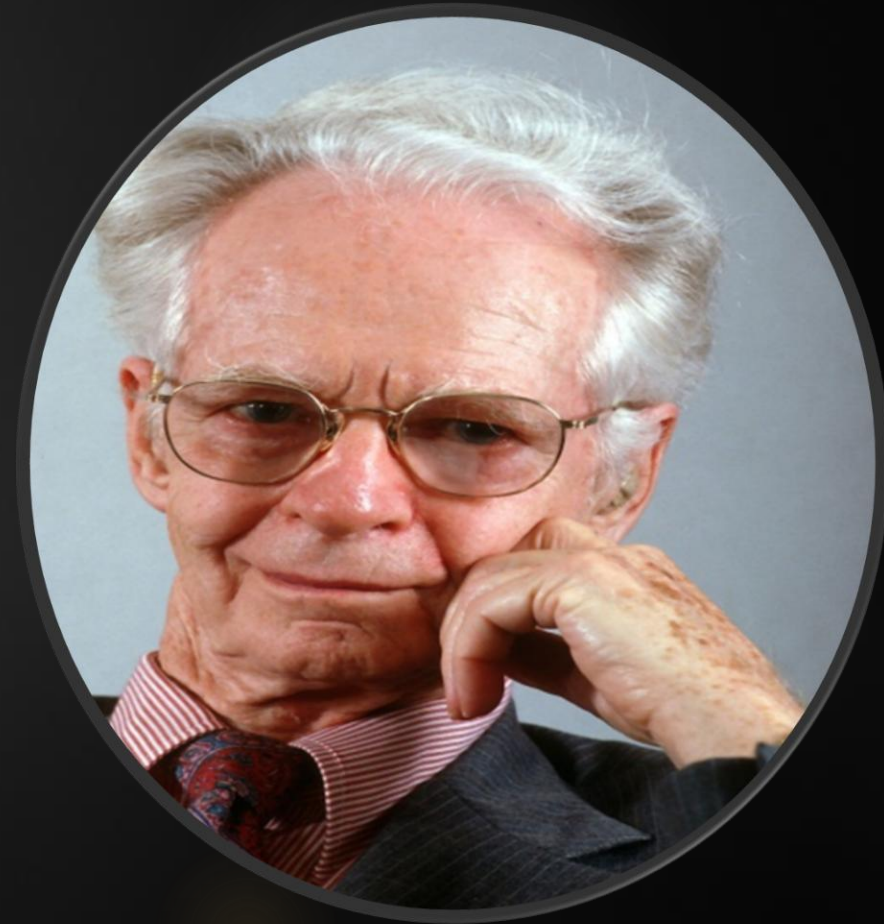


II. Operant Conditioning - Instrumental Conditioning

- ▶ First described by B. F. Skinner, an American Psychologist
- ▶ Specific consequences are associated with a voluntary behavior.
- ▶ It is a learning process in which behavior is sensitive to or controlled by its **consequences**.

OR

- ▶ It is a type of learning in which behavior is strengthened if followed by **reinforcement** or diminished if followed by **punishment**.
- ▶ Involves applying reinforcement or punishment after a behavior.



Operant Conditioning

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graph TD; OC[Operant Conditioning] --> R[Reinforcement<br/>Increase behaviour]; OC --> P[Punishment<br/>Decrease behaviour]; R --> PR[Positive Reinforcement]; R --> NR[Negative Reinforcement]; P --> PP[Positive Punishment]; P --> NP[Negative Punishment];
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Reinforcement

Increase behaviour

Positive
Reinforcement

Negative
Reinforcement

Punishment

Decrease behaviour

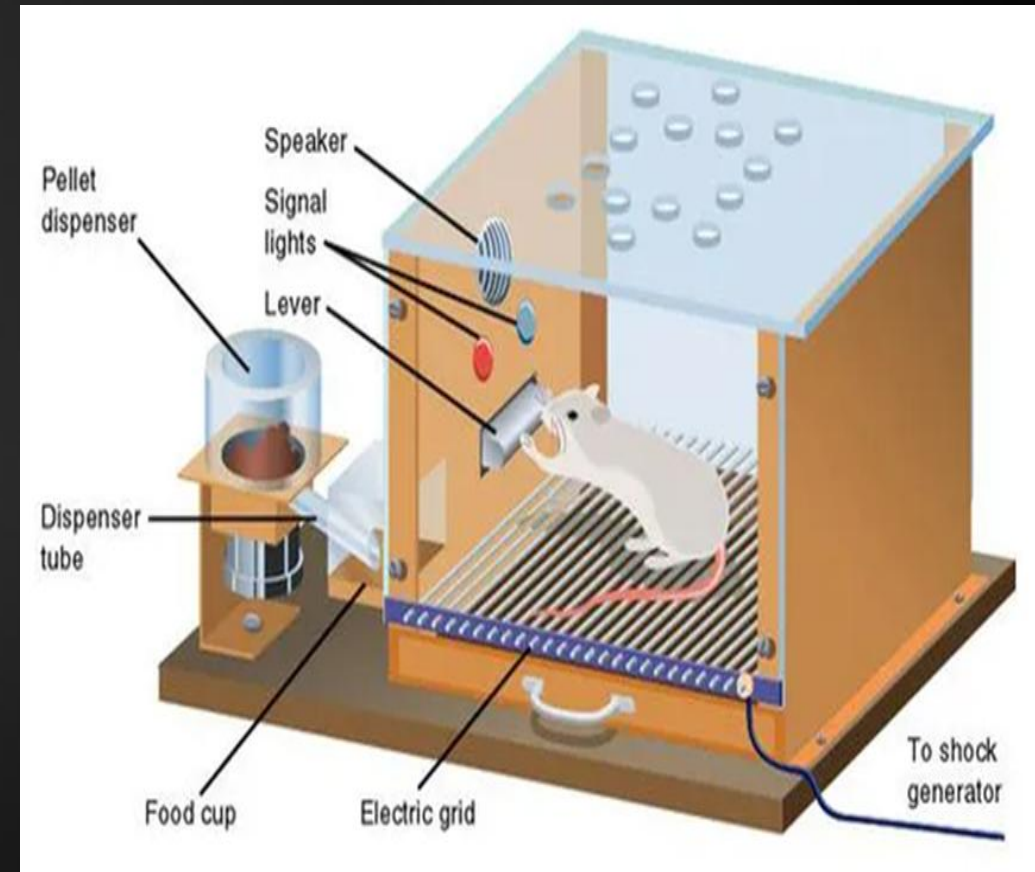
Positive
Punishment

Negative
Punishment

Skinner Box

- ▶ The "Skinner box" device was a chamber that contained a bar or key that an animal could press in order to receive food, water, or some other form of reinforcement.
- ▶ A Skinner box, also known as an operant conditioning chamber, is a device used to objectively record an animal's behavior in a compressed time frame.

An animal can be rewarded or punished for engaging in certain behaviors, such as lever pressing (for rats) or key pecking (for pigeons).





Stimulus: Light bulb

Response/Behavior: Peck on the key

Reward: food

“Pecking behavior is being rewarded.”

“Now the pigeon will respond on the light bulb to peck on the key”

Pecking behavior is strengthened.

COMPONENTS OF OPERANT CONDITIONING



- ▶ **Reinforcement** is any event that strengthens or increases the likelihood of behavior it follows. (Positive Reinforcers, Negative Reinforcers)
- ▶ In both of these cases of reinforcement, the behavior increases.
- ▶ Reinforcement is used to help increase the probability that a specific behavior will occur in the future by delivering or removing a stimulus immediately after a behavior.
- ▶ Another way to put it is that reinforcement, if done correctly, results in a behavior occurring more frequently in the future.

Positive reinforcement

- ▶ **Positive reinforcement** *presenting* a motivating/reinforcing stimulus to the person after the desired behavior is exhibited, making the behavior more likely to happen in the future. In situations that reflect positive reinforcement, a response or behavior is strengthened by the addition of something, such as praise or a direct reward.
- ▶ **For example:** 1. A mother gives her son praise (positive stimulus) for doing homework (behavior).
- 2. The little boy receives gifts (positive stimulus) for every A he earns on his report card (behavior).

Negative reinforcement

- ▶ **Negative reinforcers** involve the removal of an unfavorable events or outcomes after the display of a behavior. In these situations, a response is strengthened by the removal of something considered unpleasant.
- ▶ **For Example:** Bob does the dishes (behavior) in order to stop his mother's nagging (aversive stimulus).
- ▶ Doing away with homework for the weekend if students behave well in class

How to practice reinforcement with kids?

POSITIVE



Making their favorite dish after they finish their homework.

Taking them to a park if they clean their room.

Clapping and cheering them every time they solve a math problem!

Complying with a request if they ask you politely.

NEGATIVE



Studying really hard to avoid getting failed in the exams.

Putting one's toys at the right place after playing to avoid getting them lost or misplaced.

Doing their homework on time to save their television privileges.

Eating healthy to avoid falling sick.



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- ▶ **Punishment**, is the presentation of an adverse event or outcome that causes a decrease in the behavior it follows. (Positive Punishment, Negative Punishment)
 - ▶ In both of these cases of punishment, the behavior decreases.

Positive punishment

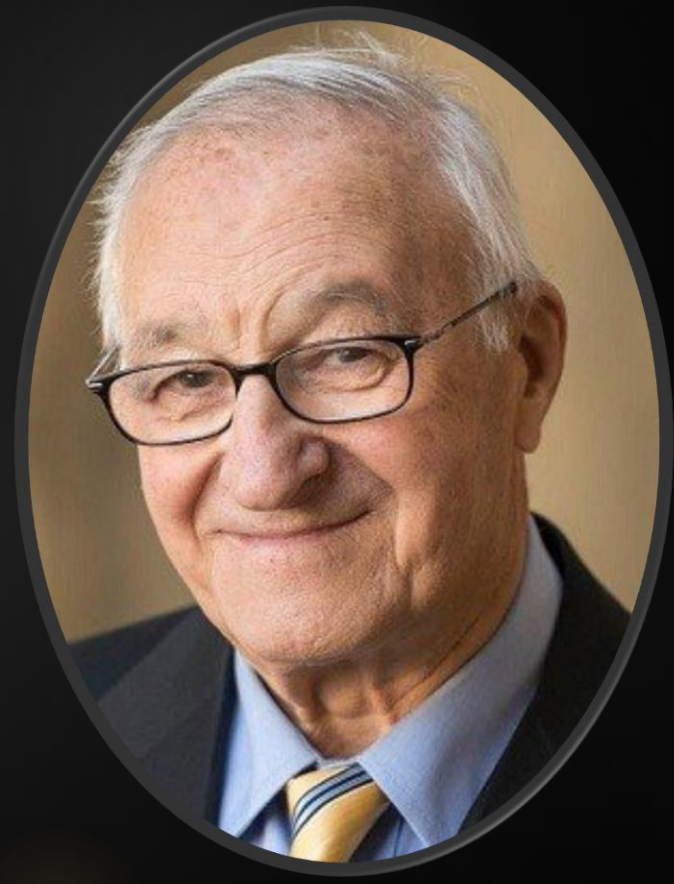
- ▶ **Positive punishment** sometimes referred to as punishment by application, involves the presentation of an unfavorable event or outcome in order to weaken the response it follows.
 - ▶ **For example:** 1. An employee exhibits bad behavior at work and the boss criticizes him. The behavior will decrease because of the boss's criticism.
2. In an experiment, the subject received a slight electric shock when they got an answer wrong.

Negative punishment

- ▶ **Negative punishment**, also known as punishment by removal, occurs when an favorable event or outcome is removed after a behavior occurs.
- ▶ **For example:** 1. Taking the student's phone or tablet because of improper use during the class
- ▶ 2. A third-grade boy yells at another student during class, so his teacher takes away "good behavior" tokens that can be redeemed for prizes.

III. Observational Learning/Social Learning theory

- ▶ Albert Bandura OC was a Canadian-American Psychologist
- ▶ Observational learning is a process in which learning occurs through observing and imitating others.
- ▶ Replicating others' novel behavior through observation and imitation; also known as *vicarious learning, modeling, or social learning*.
- ▶ Social learning theory considers how both environmental and cognitive factors interact to influence human learning and behavior
- ▶ It is based on the principle of *modifying or adopting new behavior* after *observing another* individual performing it.



Cont.

- ▶ Individuals that are observed are called **models**.
- ▶ The observer will either perform or avoid the behavior based on the consequence the model received after doing the behavior.
- ▶ In society, children are surrounded by many influential models, such as parents within the family, characters on children's TV, friends within their peer group and teachers at school.
- ▶ For Example: Henry learns not to jump on the coffee table, because he watched his brother get into trouble for doing so last week.

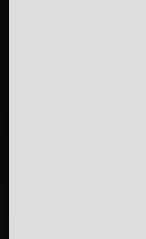
Bobo Doll Experiment (Albert Bandura, 1961)

A study of aggression

- ▶ Albert Bandura (1961) conducted a controlled experiment study to investigate if social behaviors (i.e., aggression) can be acquired by observation and imitation
- ▶ Albert Bandura let a group of kindergarteners watch a film of an adult violently attacking an inflatable plastic toy shaped like Bobo the Clown, by hitting it, sitting on it, hammering it, and so forth.
- ▶ He then let the children into a room with Bobo dolls.
- ▶ The children precisely imitated the adult's behavior, excitedly attacking Bobo doll.
- ▶ Their behavior was a type of observational learning







THE BOBO DOLL EXPERIMENT BY BANDURA

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eqNaLerMNOE>

▶ **Aggression is a learned behavior.**

LIST OF REINFORCEMENTS (Examples)

- ▶ Praise and nonverbal communication (e.g., smile, nod, thumbs up)
- ▶ social attention (e.g., a conversation, special time with the teacher or a peer)
- ▶ tangibles such as stickers, new pencils or washable tattoos
- ▶ activities or privileges such as playing a game, sitting in a special place in the class, drawing, writing, coloring, going to recess or gym early, having extra computer time
- ▶ secondary positive reinforcements (such as checkmarks, tokens or money) for students to accumulate in order to acquire tangibles or be allowed to participate in special activities.

LIST OF PUNISHMENTS (Examples)

- ▶ Yelling – scolding, name calling, demanding
- ▶ Withdrawing or Withholding – taking away privileges which may or may not have anything to do with their unacceptable behavior
- ▶ Grounding – not allowing them to do anything but what is (according to the parents) necessary
- ▶ Isolation – giving them “time outs”, alone and away from everyone else

